

ERIC A. J. WILLIAMSON

Director of Compliance & Risk | Principal Consultant | Regulatory Advisory

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished financial services executive with more than 25 years of comprehensive experience spanning regulatory oversight, risk management, compliance, and senior trading roles across global financial institutions. Former FCA Manager with distinguished regulatory authority experience, personally responsible for supervising 264 wholesale banking entities and a founding member of the FCA Crypto Committee. Extensive expertise in digital assets, blockchain technology, ESG frameworks, and regulatory transformation. Proven track record in enterprise risk management, AML/CFT, financial crime prevention, policy development, and strategic stakeholder engagement with regulators and C-suite executives across multiple jurisdictions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Enterprise Risk Management (Credit, Market, Operational, Conduct, ESG)
- FCA Regulatory Supervision & Enforcement (S165/S166, VREQ, Watch List)
- AML/CFT, Financial Crime & Transaction Monitoring
- Digital Asset Compliance: Crypto, Tokenisation, CBDC, Stablecoins
- MiFID II/MiFIR, MAR, EMIR, DTR, SSR, SMCR, UK MLRs
- AI Governance & Digital Transformation Frameworks
- ESG/SDR, Climate Risk & Greenwashing Guidance
- CBEST Cyber Resilience & Operational Risk
- Capital Markets: Fixed Income, Credit Derivatives, Structured Products
- Board-Level Stakeholder & Regulatory Relationship Management
- Policy Development, Regulatory Strategy & Horizon Scanning
- Cross-Border Multi-Jurisdictional Regulatory Frameworks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Digital Commonwealth Ltd | *Director of Compliance and Risk* January 2024 – Present

- Lead enterprise-wide risk identification and management for an independent industry organisation representing AI, Blockchain, DePIN, Digital Assets, and Web3 sectors across Commonwealth member states.
- Develop and implement comprehensive risk frameworks, ESG and climate policies aligned with evolving FCA and international regulatory requirements.
- Oversee operational and cyber risk assessments; coordinate cross-functional teams for effective risk monitoring and reporting.
- Provide strategic regulatory advisory to FinTech firms on FCA compliance, financial promotions, and emerging regulatory requirements.
- Author weekly regulatory intelligence publications covering digital assets, stablecoins, MiCA implementation, UK crypto regulation, and global developments.
- Serve on the advisory board of KitheTech, providing regulatory framework guidance for innovative financial services.

We Provide Solutions Ltd | Principal Consultant

November 2023 – Present

- Advise financial institutions and FinTech firms on Enterprise Risk Management framework design and implementation.
- Design risk assessment methodologies for digital transformation initiatives and digital asset environments, including tokenisation lifecycle management.
- Provide strategic policy guidance on regulatory positioning, AML/CFT, AI governance, and emerging technology policy across UK, US, EU, and Asian markets.
- Deliver training on emerging risks in AI, digital finance, and regulatory compliance for senior management and boards.
- Serve on the advisory board of Mpowa, providing regulatory framework guidance for innovative financial services.

EY | Senior Manager, Wholesale Banking Transformation

November 2022 – November 2023

- Led risk assessment workstreams for digital asset initiatives including CBDC, stablecoins, and tokenisation lifecycle management.
- Served as Subject Matter Expert on capital markets best practices: ESG/SDR, greenwashing, T+1 settlement, middle office transformation, and MiFID II.
- Managed the Consolidated Exchange Tape Project, overseeing feasibility study and cross-functional workstreams.
- Delivered SMCR oversight guidance on fitness and propriety processes, accountability mappings, and certification regimes.
- Appointed EY Knowledge Champion: delivered mentor support, monthly Lunch & Learn sessions, topical points of view, and a daily internal market newsletter.

MoNations.io | Principal Consultant

September 2021 – November 2022

- Designed and implemented comprehensive risk management frameworks for digital asset firms navigating FCA registration.
- Created risk assessment methodologies for crypto-related operations including wallet screening and source-of-funds verification.
- Developed governance frameworks, policies, procedures, and systems and controls for crypto asset businesses.
- Provided specialist consultancy on AML/CFT obligations specific to digital assets, transaction monitoring, and regulatory reporting.

UK Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) | Manager, Overseas Wholesale Banks Supervision

January 2019 – July 2021

- Led risk-based supervision of 264 wholesale banking entities as Portfolio Lead, providing comprehensive regulatory oversight and strategic direction.
- Supervised the team overseeing all Japanese, Chinese, and Asian-registered firms in the OWB portfolio with policy development responsibilities.
- Implemented enhanced risk identification and monitoring frameworks; conducted comprehensive firm evaluations and developed key risk indicators.
- Led regulatory interventions including MAR and STOR reviews, S165/S166 investigations, VREQ interventions, watchlist placements, and remediation programmes.
- Chaired Annual Supervisory Meetings and Accountable Contacts Meetings with C-suite executives on firm evaluations and compliance strategy.
- Founding member of FCA Crypto, LIBOR, and Firm Risk Committees, providing Executive Committee insights on evolving regulatory frameworks and digital asset oversight.
- Coordinated cross-border risk assessment initiatives with global regulators: PRA, JFSA, BOJ, MAS, and other international regulatory bodies.
- Led thematic work on CEO and SMF16/17 round tables, 5 Conduct Questions, Brexit transition risks, LIBOR remediation, and MiFID II follow-up programmes.
- Conducted TRC and CBEST reviews; led FCA Board review with best practice recommendations.
- Appointed FCA Do No Harm and Mental Health Champion; delivered Lunch & Learn sessions on compliance best practices.

EAJW Solutions | Lead Consultant for Financial Institutions

August 2015 – December 2018

- Advised a large regional US bank on EMEA, Asia, and Japanese business expansion opportunities.
- Developed Brexit and MiFID II regulatory strategy and positioning for international operations.
- Established a risk framework for a Dublin-based regulatory operation focused on Article 47 EU equivalence, including systems and controls design.

Career Break

August 2014 – August 2015

Wells Fargo Bank | Managing Director, Credit Products | London / Charlotte, NC July 2004 – August 2014

- Developed and implemented enterprise-wide risk management frameworks across global trading and risk management operations.
- Led global risk identification and reporting initiatives; rebuilt trading and risk management reporting capabilities across core business lines.
- Actively managed legacy and structured credit product portfolios with comprehensive sector and counterparty risk identification and reporting.
- Established governance structures for risk monitoring across multiple jurisdictions and introduced regular governance meetings on market developments.
- Led the London business model reorganisation resulting in more efficient capital usage and enhanced risk and compliance reporting during the 2007/08 Wachovia transition.
- Developed the US domestic trading franchise integrating fixed income cash and CDS products, enhanced trading tools, and capital reporting capabilities.

Bank One Europe (JP Morgan) | Managing Director, Head of European Credit Products

April 2003 – July 2004

- Built capital markets trading and distribution capabilities to support the Bank's core business objectives, including a structured credit product platform.
- Developed a single cross-border pricing and risk tool for the credit trading platform, integrating market pricing information delivery to institutional and retail clients.
- Oversaw successful local business and employee transition from Bank One to JP Morgan across European and US operations.

Bank of America | Managing Director, International & US Domestic Credit Trading | London /

Charlotte / Hong Kong / Tokyo

June 1999 – April 2003

- Integrated global trading desks across Charlotte, London, Hong Kong, and Tokyo, covering all fixed-income products.
- Developed and managed high-performing trading teams across multiple jurisdictions and time zones.
- Implemented comprehensive risk management and reporting tools for the Bank Finance franchise.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Professional Certifications

- Advanced Certified Financial Crime Specialist (ACFCS) – 2022
- FCA CybSafe Diploma for Security Measures and Risk Reduction – 2020
- FCA Comprehensive Supervision Training Programme – All Asset Classes, Leadership, Strategy, and Regulatory Judgement
- FCA Firm Resolution and Wind Down Programmes
- European Banking Association Supervision Review and Evaluation Process (SREP) – 2019
- LSE Certified Course: Cryptocurrency, Blockchain and Disruption – 2018

Academic

- Honorary Bachelor of Science, Business Administration – Fielding University, Santa Barbara, USA (2004)

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & DISTINCTIONS

- Regulatory Innovation Leadership: Founding member of the FCA Crypto, LIBOR, and Firm Risk Committees, directly influencing UK regulatory policy and digital asset frameworks.
- Distinguished Regulatory Service: Successfully supervised 264 wholesale banking entities, achieving comprehensive risk reduction through enhanced governance.
- International Policy Coordination: Built strategic relationships with senior government officials and regulatory bodies including PRA, JFSA, BOJ, MAS, and SEC.
- Digital Asset Pioneer: Early expert in cryptocurrency and blockchain regulatory frameworks, contributing to industry policy and best practices at a national level.
- Cross-Border Excellence: Managed complex multi-jurisdictional regulatory environments across UK, EU, US, and Asian frameworks throughout career.
- Leadership Recognition: Appointed FCA Do No Harm and Mental Health Champion; EY Knowledge Champion; recognised for mentor support and professional development.
- Business Transformation: Led comprehensive London business model reorganisation for Wells Fargo, resulting in enhanced capital efficiency and risk management infrastructure.
- Global Operations: Built and managed high-performing trading teams across London, Charlotte, Hong Kong, Tokyo, and New York.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Regulatory Frameworks

FCA Handbook, MAR, MiFID II/MiFIR, EMIR, DTR, SSR, AML/CFT, UK MLRs, POCA, SAR/STR, SEC Rules, SMCR, Brexit implementation, LIBOR transition, FATF standards, GDPR, EU regulatory frameworks

Digital Assets & Innovation

Cryptocurrency regulation, Blockchain governance, Tokenisation frameworks, Stablecoin regulation, CBDC policy, MiCA implementation, Digital asset compliance, Chainalysis and blockchain analytics, DePIN, Web3 ecosystems

Risk Management

Credit Risk, Market Risk, Operational Risk, Conduct Risk, Cyber Risk, ESG Risk, Climate Risk, Enterprise Risk Management, Three Lines of Defence, Risk appetite frameworks, Stress testing, Scenario analysis

Systems & Technology

Trade surveillance systems, Transaction reporting, AML transaction monitoring, Risk reporting tools, Pricing and risk platforms, Electronic trading platforms, Market data systems, Consolidated tape, T+1 settlement

Capital Markets Products

Corporate bonds, Credit derivatives (CDS, CLO), Structured credit products, Fixed income products, Government bonds, Securitisation, Syndicated loans, Treasury products, Derivatives (OTC and exchange-traded)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS & INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENTS

Affiliations

- Member and Adviser, UK Stablecoin Standard Policy (stablecoinstandard.com)
- Member, Global Digital Finance (gdf.io)
- Member, Stablecoins Unblocked (stablecoinsunblocked.com)
- Active Participant, Crypto Mondays (cryptomondays.io)
- Contributing Writer, The Digital Commonwealth – publications include: DCW Daily Brief, DCW Frontier Focus, DCW Institute, DCW Breaking It Down, DCW Cover (Insurance), DCW Research, DCW Advisory, and DCW Weekly Roundup
- Regular Subject Matter Expert Consultant, Guidepoint and AlphaSights

Speaking Engagements

- Regular presenter at Digital Commonwealth Manson House Summits on Financial Services Transformation, Regulation, Compliance, AI, and Digital Assets/Tokenisation
- Subject Matter Expert speaker at Star Compliance Summits
- Invited to speak at the House of Parliament: GSR Foundation, hosted by the London Foundation for Banking and Finance
- Invited lecturer to students, alumni, and C-Suite business leaders at Ohio State University and the Risk Institute
- Speaker at Digital Asset and Digital Transformation forums

Industry Network

- Active contributor to Digital Commonwealth Prime: an exclusive network of more than 1,000 C-suite executives, founders, and regulators worldwide specialising in Digital Assets, Financial Services, Cryptocurrency, Web3, Tokenisation, Exchanges, Compliance, and Regulatory frameworks.

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